

JACOB SMITH



CONTACT

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- San Francisco CA
- jresmith.com

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate, 01/24, AWS
- JNCIA-Junos Certification, 01/18, Juniper Networks

SKILLS

Cloud & Platform Engineering

- AWS (infrastructure design, high-availability patterns)
- Infrastructure as Code (Terraform, Ansible)
- Kubernetes (cluster design, manifests, Helm, GitOps with ArgoCD)
- CI/CD Pipelines (GitHub Actions, GitLab Pipelines)

Observability & Reliability

SITE RELIABILITY ENGINEER | PLATFORM ENGINEER

SUMMARY

SRE and Platform-focused engineer with over a decade of experience across infrastructure, automation, and operational reliability. Strong background in Linux systems, monitoring, incident response, and building internal tooling that improves deployment speed and system resilience. Recently expanded skillset into cloud-native technologies — Terraform, Kubernetes, and modern IaC workflows — through structured lab projects and portfolio work. Now transitioning from IT management back into hands-on engineering roles focused on reliability, automation, and scalable platform design.

PORTFOLIO PROJECT

'Workhorse' AWS Terraform + Kubernetes Platform (Personal Lab, 2026)

A production-style cloud platform built to practice read SRE and Platform Engineering workflows.

- Built an **AWS EKS** cluster using **Terraform** modules (VPC, node groups, IAM, cluster config).
- Implemented GitOps deployments with **ArgoCD**.
- Built full observability stack using **Prometheus**, Loki, Grafana, yace, alloy, and promtail.

- Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, yace, alloy, promtail
- SLA/SLO/SLI design
- Incident response & root-cause analysis

Systems Engineering

- Linux Administration (Ubuntu, Red Hat, FreeBSD)
- Networking fundamentals (DNS, routing, load balancing)
- High availability & disaster recovery
- Virtualization & VM host management

Programming & Automation

- Bash, Python

EDUCATION

07/2015

BSc - Mathematics

Lancaster University
Lancaster, UK

- First Class Honours
- Various modules across mathematical and statistical fields

- Applied **SLA/SLO/SLI** framework to define reliability targets and monitoring priorities.

EXPERIENCE

DevOps Engineer (Infrastructure) Darktrace

03/2019 - 01/2022

- Acted as on-call responder for production incidents, using automated monitoring scripts to meaningfully reduce incident response times.
- Authored runbooks for service crashes & deployment failures and reducing diagnosis time.
- Led blameless postmortems following high-severity incidents, driving root-cause fixes that reduced repeat occurrences of application and database outages.
- Built CI/CD automation, increasing deployment frequency by 75% within 3 months.
- Designed and deployed an Ansible Automation Platform, cutting deployment times by 66%.

Infrastructure Engineer (Platform & Reliability) Darktrace

01/2022 - 05/2024

- Served as primary escalation point for business-critical outages across AMER, coordinating cross-functional response outside standard support hours.
- Led post-incident reviews for major outages — documenting root cause and impact, and tracking remediation items to closure.
- Built and maintained a runbook library for critical infrastructure, reducing MTTR for recurring incident types.
- Designed and implemented disaster recovery infrastructure using Veeam, improving backup/recovery posture.
- Owned infrastructure and virtualization platforms supporting multiple technical teams across AMER.

US IT Support Manager
Darktrace | San Francisco, California

05/2024 - Current

- Own infrastructure automation and reliability initiatives across AMER, driving a 65% improvement in operational performance through scripting, process redesign, and technical upskilling.
- Lead root-cause analysis on high-severity incidents, coordinating cross-functional engineering response through resolution and into prevention.
- Partner directly with engineering to diagnose recurring infrastructure issues and drive fixes at the source rather than repeated triage.
- Redesign operational processes around core SRE principles — incident response discipline, RCA, and proactive monitoring — reducing reliance on reactive support.

Earlier Roles (Sysadmin & Operations Support)

Darktrace | Cambridge, UK

08/2015 - 03/2019

- Strengthened network reliability through proactive monitoring solutions.
- Delivered on-call technical support ensuring SLAs were met.
- Developed strong Linux troubleshooting and problem-solving skills.

PROJECTS

- **Professional Website Hosting - jresmith.com** Hosted a personal professional website on Amazon S3 with CloudFront for global distribution, TLS, and caching, 07/2026